



VOTE ON ACCOUNT **ASSAM BUDGET** 2026-2027



SPEECH OF
SMTI. AJANTA NEOG
FINANCE MINISTER, ASSAM
17 FEBRUARY, 2026

Hon'ble Speaker Sir,

1. Five years ago, under the dynamic leadership of the Hon'ble Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, I began a historic journey as the first woman Finance Minister of Assam, with a great honour and deep humility in my heart.
2. I presented the five full budgets of our Government, guided by the ideals of Pandit Deendayal Upadhyaya's Integral Humanism and Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee's cultural nationalism, sowing the seeds of a firm, steadfast, and progressive Assam. The aim was to fulfil the hopes and aspirations of the sons of the soil and the indigenous people, and to create a new chapter in the history of a developed and self-reliant Assam.
3. I presented my first budget amidst the unprecedented crisis of COVID-19, guided by the compassion of a mother's heart. In those dark hours, when our economy was strained and our people faced immense hardship, my only focus was to provide a healing touch and lay a strong foundation for our future.
4. Giving priority to the Honourable Prime Minister's vision of "*Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas, Sabka Prayas*," our government embarked on a journey of transformation with the firm resolve to build a developed and self-reliant Assam. In our policy-making,

we accorded due importance to Assamese identity, national culture, linguistic heritage, and the eternal rights of the indigenous sons of the soil over their land and roots.

5. Today, I stand in this august House not merely to seek approval for expenditure, but to speak about a transforming Assam. This five-year journey reminds us of the immortal dream of *Sudhakantha*, Bharat Ratna Dr. Bhupen Hazarika. Decades ago, he sang:

জিলিকাব লুইতৰে পাৰ,
এন্ধাৰৰ ভেটা ভাঙি
প্ৰাগজ্যোতিষত বয়
জেউতি নিজৰাৰে ধাৰ।

I humbly submit that we have moved steadily in the direction of turning that song into reality. Darkness has given way to a developed Assam, where every citizen is a companion in our journey of progress.

6. At the very outset, I express my heartfelt gratitude to our guide, Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi Ji. His special affection towards Assam and his unwavering support have propelled us forward on the path of *Viksit Assam*.
7. I extend my heartfelt gratitude to the Hon'ble Chief Minister, Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma, for his inspiring leadership in guiding us on this journey to fulfil the hopes and aspirations of the people.

8. I express my sincere thanks to all our alliance partners, my colleagues seated in the Opposition benches, and especially to the people of Assam, for their continuous support, trust, and guidance to this government.

Economic transformation (Arthik Navoday)

9. Sir, the foundation of the remarkable progress achieved over the last five years rests on prudent fiscal management, improved compliance, and sustained efforts to strengthen the State's own resource mobilisation.
10. I am honoured to share the good news with this August house that the 16th Finance Commission has recognised our exceptional performance in fiscal parameters in the last 5 years by increasing Assam's inter-se share to 3.258%, arresting the downward trend seen in recent years. This has improved Assam's position and will result in an unprecedented devolution above Rs.50,000 crore in the upcoming year itself.
11. While the global economy faced headwinds, Assam emerged as India's growth engine. As per the Reserve Bank of India (RBI)'s latest assessment, Assam has emerged as India's fastest-growing state. At constant prices, the State's Gross State Domestic Product expanded by 45% between FY 2019-20 and FY 2024-25, significantly outperforming the national average growth of 29%.

12. Our Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) at current prices is projected to rise from Rs.4,10,724 crore in FY 2021–22 to Rs.7,45,293 crore in FY 2025–26 (AE), reflecting a staggering growth rate of over 17%. I am happy to announce that the Economic Survey of Assam has projected a growth rate of 16.93%, with the Gross State Domestic Product estimated at Rs.8,71,451 crore for FY 2026–27.
13. With this growth momentum, the State is poised to become a ten-lakh-crore (one-million-crore) economy by 2028, well ahead of our commitment to achieve it by 2030.
14. This economic expansion is also translating into higher incomes for our people. I am proud to share that the per-capita income (at current prices) of Assam has more than doubled, from Rs.86,947 in FY 2020-21 to Rs.1,85,429 in FY 2025-26, representing an increase of 113%.
15. Between FY 2020-21 and FY 2024-25, our 83% growth in per-capita income has made us the fastest-growing State in the country in terms of per-capita income, clearly demonstrating that our growth is reaching people's lives, not just economic reports.
16. The most significant indicator of our economic growth is our Own Tax Revenue, which has grown at an average rate of 13% in the last five years. Overall, Own Tax Revenue increased by 75% from Rs.17,134 crore in FY 2020-21 to Rs.30,052 crore in FY 2024-25.

17. Historically, many Northeastern states have relied heavily on Central Devolution and Grants-in-Aid. As our Own Source Revenue now accounts for 37% of total revenue receipts, up from 30% in FY 2015-16, it has reduced our dependence on central transfers and ensures a stronger, self-sustaining internal economy.
18. With stronger revenues and improved fiscal management, the scale and effectiveness of public spending have expanded significantly. The size of our Budget has more than doubled from Rs.72,573 crore in FY 2015-16 to Rs.1,55,985 crore in FY 2025-26 (BE), which will touch Rs.2 lakh crore in revised estimates.
19. For decades, budgets in Assam were mere wish-lists where money remained trapped in files. In FY 2015-16, our budget utilization was a stagnant 58%. We have shattered that culture of delay and administrative inertia. We have moved from 58% budget utilisation in FY 2015-16 to record budget utilization of 85% in FY 2024-25.
20. Importantly, this expansion has been accompanied by a decisive shift towards productive spending. Capital expenditure has risen over eight times, from Rs.2,951 crore in FY 2015-16 to Rs.26,409 crore in FY 2024-25, reflecting a massive growth of 795%.
21. This capital push has been further supported by the Government of India. Assam has been one of the major beneficiaries under the scheme for *Special Assistance to States for Capital Investment*, receiving over

Rs.25,000 crore during the last five years. In this context, I express my sincere gratitude to Hon'ble Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman Ji for her continued encouragement and support in accelerating Assam's economic and fiscal transformation.

22. While capital spending has expanded, borrowing has been managed prudently. Since FY 2021-22, Assam has undertaken cumulative capital expenditure of Rs.1,04,896 crore¹, while the increase in outstanding debt has been Rs.84,037 crore, indicating that borrowings have been largely channelled towards asset creation.
23. State's Debt-to-GSDP ratio² stands at 25.52% in FY 2024-25 today, placing Assam at 21st position among 28 States, thereby reflecting a sustainable and controlled debt trajectory within permissible fiscal norms.
24. In addition to budgetary resources, Assam has effectively leveraged Externally Aided Projects (EAP) to augment public investment. The size of ongoing EAPs has increased substantially from projects worth around Rs.15,000 crore in 2021 to about Rs.56,000 crore at present, spanning a wide range of sectors.
25. Complementing public investment, institutional credit flow within the State has also strengthened. The Credit–Deposit (CD) ratio increased from 56.09% in March 2021 to 74.48% in December 2025³, reflecting improved deployment of bank deposits within Assam.

¹ till 31st January 2026

² Outstanding debt excludes Reserve Funds, Deposit and Advances, Contingency Funds

³ Source: State Level Bankers' Committee (SLBC) reports

26. This is reflected in priority sector advances of Rs.3,69,343 crore since FY 2021-22, supporting agriculture, MSMEs and allied activities, and reinforcing inclusive growth.
27. Sir, we are not just a Government that spends; we are a Government that builds wealth. Today, the combined assets of our Public Sector Enterprises exceed a staggering Rs.35,000 crore⁴.
28. Our strategic investment in Numaligarh Refinery Limited, recently accorded *Navaratna* status, continues to strengthen, with the value of the State Government's stake now exceeding Rs.5,100 crore.
29. We have fortified Assam with a financial shield of nearly Rs.10,000 crore⁵, held within our Sinking and Redemption Funds (Consolidated Sinking Fund/ Guarantee Redemption Fund/AIFA Sinking Fund, etc.).
30. With record cash reserves and a robust resource base, we have moved from a state of 'Survival' to a state of 'Sovereign Strength'.

Atal Avichal Agragami Asom

31. Sir, a defining achievement of the last five years has been the restoration of peace and stability across the State. Gone are the days of fragility and hesitation. Today, the world sees a new Assam—a state that stands *Atal* (firm) in safeguarding our identity, culture and civilisational values; remains *Avichal* (uncompromising)

⁴ Source : CAG Report on State PSEs, 2023-24

⁵ till November 2025

in preserving peace and harmony, and sprints forward as an *Aragami* (forward looking) force in *Viksit Bharat*, on the path of inclusive growth.

32. Together with the Government of India, our Government has secured four historic peace accords with ULFA, Karbi, Adivasi and the DNLA groups — paving the way for enduring peace, stability, and integration. I sincerely thank Hon'ble Union Home Minister Shri Amit Shah Ji for playing an instrumental role in this development.
33. In the Union Budget 2026–27, the Government of India has earmarked Rs.500 crore as the first tranche of a Rs.5,000 crore special development and rehabilitation package under the 2023 peace accord with the United Liberation Front of Asom (ULFA). This is to support projects aimed at sustainable livelihoods, reintegration and long-term peace in Assam.
34. Under the Memorandum of Settlement, our Government has committed Rs.3,000 crore from its own resources toward infrastructure and development projects linked to the ULFA peace agreement, complementing the Central support.
35. Since 2021, sustained peace efforts in Assam have led to a total of 9,022 former cadres depositing 1,012 sophisticated weapons.
36. Over the past five years, our Government has rehabilitated these misguided youths under the Surrender-cum-Rehabilitation framework, providing

financial support packages that include Rs.4 lakh fixed deposits and monthly stipends, along with assistance for livelihood activities.

37. Since our Government assumed office, Assam has made decisive progress in resolving long-standing border disputes and strengthening regional harmony by signing the inter-state Boundary arrangements with Meghalaya (2022) and Arunachal Pradesh (2023).
38. Our commitment to restore peace and normalcy within Assam is clearly reflected in the rollback of the Armed Forces (Special Powers) Act. Once covering the entire State, its application has been reduced today to only three districts.
39. Through sustained and lawful action against encroachment, we have recovered approximately 1.45 lakh bighas of government land for public use and future development.
40. In the last five years since 2021, Assam has made over 24,000 drug-related arrests and seized drugs worth more than Rs.3001 crore, over seven times the recoveries made between 2011 and 2015.
41. Our Government has raised 5 new Commando Battalions, recruited 22,606 Police personnel and other staff in the last 5 years and promoted 43,697 personnel, steadily moving towards a fully professional zero vacancy force.

42. We have established a premier training institution Lachit Barphukan Police Academy, the new Commissioner of Police office in Guwahati, 2 new District Jails in Bodoland Territorial Region, and constructed/modernised 112 police stations under the MOITRI (Mission for Overall Improvement of Thanas for Responsive Image) scheme with the aim of creating public-friendly, professional police.
43. Assam ranked first in the country in implementing the new criminal laws, including the *Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita*, achieving an implementation score of around 78.13%, well above the national average of 53.69%⁶.
44. A multi pronged campaign against the social menace of child marriage involved strict enforcement of the Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, proactive police action and community awareness alongside schemes like *Mukhya Mantrir Nijut Moina*.
45. Our resolve to protect the woman's dignity and strengthen her rights is further continued with passing the Assam Prohibition of Polygamy Act, 2025, a decisive reform reflecting our commitment to justice within the home.
46. These efforts have created a safer, more stable Assam, where peace is not temporary, but the foundation for lasting development. As our Hon'ble Chief Minister said at Davos, Assam is moving "*from guns to (semiconductor) chips*"— সংঘাতৰ পৰা সুযোগলৈ, অস্থিৰতাৰ পৰা উদ্ভাৱনলৈ।

⁶ Source: Ministry of Home Affairs assessments

Resolve to Realisation (*Sankalpor pora Siddhi loi*)

47. Sir, the budgets I have presented in the last 5 years, were far more than a mere financial statement; they were a solemn commitment to building a Resilient Assam and I can say with humble pride that we have fulfilled our commitments through multiple social sector Flagship schemes and assistance, ensuring inclusive growth.
48. *Orunodoi* is our Government's promise in action. We expanded its coverage from 19 lakh families at the launch in 2021, to nearly 40 lakh *Orunodoi poriyals* today, including *Divyangjan*, transgender persons, and other vulnerable groups, making it the largest social assistance programme in the history of Assam.
49. Under the *Mukhyamantri Mahila Udyamita Abhiyaan*, we have empowered over 30.63 lakh eligible women by providing Rs.10,000 as seed capital, per SHG member. Today, I am proud to present that 8.80 lakh *Lakhpati Baideo* are the engines driving our rural economy.
50. Our Government provided Rs.2,304 crore as incentive and relief to 12.71 lakh small borrowers, under the Assam Microfinance Incentive and Relief Scheme (AMFIRS) 2021, breaking the chains of debt that had stifled our villages for decades.
51. To commemorate 200 years of "Assam Tea", our Government launched the *Mukhya Mantrir Eti Koli, Duti Paat*, extending a one-time assistance of Rs.5,000 to

over 6 lakh tea garden workers and employees, with a total outlay of Rs.342 crore.

52. Sir, they mocked us when we promised 1 Lakh Government Jobs. Today, I place on record that we have not just met that target; we have crushed it, by providing over 1.58 lakh appointments, transparently.
53. Through the flagship scheme of our Government - Chief Minister's *Atmanirbhar Asom Abhijan* (CMAAA), we have provided financial assistance of Rs.1 lakh per beneficiary to more than 25,000 beneficiaries and Rs.2.5 lakh to 221 professional category beneficiaries, and further providing 75,000 beneficiaries the total financial assistance of approx. Rs.750 crore.
54. Being sensitive to the needs of the vulnerable sections of our society, we have enhanced the Old Age Pension from Rs.250 to Rs.400 and Widow Pension from Rs.300 to Rs.1250, supporting 8,06,170 beneficiaries under the National Social Assistance Program.
55. Additionally, we have brought the old age pension to 11,59,137 beneficiaries under the *Swahid Kushal Konwar Sarbajanin Briddha Pension Achoni* (SKKSBPA) at par with *National Old Age Pension Scheme*.
56. Securing the basic right to food, we have woven a massive safety net covering 70.71 lakh families, and providing free rice to a population of over 2.49 crore citizens under the NFSA and PM *Garib Kalyan Anna Yojana*.

57. Under the ongoing drive for inclusion of 5.04 lakh new beneficiaries, we have already added more than 65 lakh beneficiaries and issued over 14.60 lakh new ration cards in just 5 years.
58. We aren't just filling stomachs; we are also nourishing the lives of our people. By providing *Masur Dal*, Sugar, and Salt at a highly subsidized combined price of just Rs.100, we have strengthened nutritional support further.
59. Our targeted public health initiatives have led to a 44% decline in Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR)⁷ in just three years, one of the highest reductions in the country. The efforts are also reflected in our Infant Mortality Rate improving nearly at twice the national pace; and institutional deliveries⁸ reaching 97% in 2024–25.
60. Our Government has supported 1.16 lakh pregnant women in tea garden areas with Rs.15,000 each under Tea Garden Wage Compensation Scheme, disbursing approx. Rs.120 crore.
61. Under *Ayushman Asom – Mukhya Mantri Jan Arogya Yojana*, over 7.17 lakh beneficiaries received cashless treatments in the last 5 years, which resulted in household savings of Rs.1258 crore.
62. Sir, in just four years, we have doubled our medical colleges from 7 to 14, and are currently investing Rs.5,500 crore to build 10 more medical colleges, which will add 4,500 beds to our healthcare system.

⁷ Source : SRS (2018-2020) to SRS (2021-2023)

⁸ Source : HMIS

63. Under the Assam Advanced Healthcare Innovation Institute (AAHII) prototype of indigenous Surgical Robot and Low Field MRI have been developed. We are also investing Rs.500 crore to install a Proton Therapy machine at GMCH.
64. In a historic partnership with Tata Trusts, we have established the Assam Cancer Care Foundation (ACCF), creating South Asia's first and largest three-tier cancer care network, bringing world-class cancer care to our own districts.
65. Beyond treatment, our network has conducted over seven (07) lakh community screenings. By catching the disease early, we are saving thousands of lives and preventing the massive costs of late-stage treatment.
66. Through *Mukhya Mantrir Nijut Moina Asoni*, our Government has committed about Rs.260 crore toward monthly financial assistance of Rs.1,000 to Rs.2,500 — supporting over 5.5 lakh girl students.
67. Similarly, under *Mukhya Mantrir Nijut Babu Scheme* monthly financial assistance of Rs.1000 to Rs.2000 will be provided now to 47,428 boys from economically weaker families enrolled in the first year of undergraduate and postgraduate courses.
68. Through the Chief Minister's *Jibon Prerana Scheme*, our Government will cover 48,319 fresh graduates with a monthly financial assistance of Rs.2,500, ensuring they have the breathing room to pursue their aspirations without immediate financial anxiety.
69. For those dedicated to deep research and innovation, under the Chief Minister's *Jibon Anuprerana Scheme*, our Government is going to provide financial assistance

to 2,125 full-time research scholars, including Divyang scholars, with support of Rs.25,000 per scholar and Rs.40,000 for Divyang scholars.

70. Under Pragyan Bharti, admission fees worth Rs.780 crore were waived off for economically weaker students, benefiting an average of 3.5 lakh UG and PG students each year.
71. High-performing colleges such as North Lakhimpur, Gurucharan, Sibsagar, Bongaigaon, Jagannath Barooah, Nagaon, and Kokrajhar have been upgraded to *Vishwavidyalaya*.
72. Sir, we have fulfilled our promise to set up Assam Skill University at Darrang. Further, we have already started constructing Swahid Kanaklata Barua State University, first full-fledged T-VET based university in the country.
73. We have also approved the establishment of “*SU-KAPHA* University, Assam” as a teaching, residential, and affiliating university.
74. We have constructed 118 Model High Schools at a cost of Rs.210 crore in tea garden areas which are already functional with all facilities and are building 100 more such schools.
75. We are building 500 Mahaprabhu Jagannath Community Hall cum Skill Centers to serve as the heart of cultural and vocational activities in our tea gardens.
76. We have taken steps to construct 9,054 Model Anganwadi Centers (AWC), out of which 3,870 centers have been completed and the remaining are underway.
77. Strengthening the education system and securing staff services, our Government provincialised 3,309 tutor

posts in 1,698 LP schools and 6,586 tutor posts in 2,107 UP schools in 2021, along with 1,539 Grade-IV employees in 1,539 UP schools in 2022, under the relevant Provincialisation Acts in Assam.

78. Through our Transfer Portal for teachers, with zero manual intervention, 42,813 teachers have successfully relocated to their preferred stations, ensuring that their minds are at peace and their hearts are in the classroom.
79. Through the similar portal for Grade-III and Grade-IV employees, 9004 employees got the desired transfers in a transparent manner.
80. From the overwhelming participation in *Khel Maharan*, 6,924 athletes fought their way to the State level, and 669 promising players have been handpicked for advanced training for national and international competitions.
81. Under *Apun Ghar*, we have given Rs.706.5 crore in interest subsidy so far to 47,277 government employees, which supported them in availing housing loans worth Rs.7,376 crore.
82. Under *Apun Bahan*, Rs.10.76 crore has been sanctioned as interest support, benefiting 6,720 government employees.
83. The *Ayushman Asom – Mukhya Mantri Lok Sevak Arogya Yojana* (AA-MMLSAY) provides cashless benefits as per CGHS rates in various empanelled hospitals across the State and nationwide, to government employees, pensioners and their dependents.
84. In line with the Government of India, we introduced a Unified Pension Scheme to offer assured, predictable

retirement benefits and also set up an 8th Pay Commission for State Government employees.

85. We have enhanced the monthly remuneration of Anganwadi Worker from Rs.6500 to Rs.8000, Anganwadi Helper from Rs.3250 to Rs.4000, POSHAN cook from Rs.1500 to Rs.2000, ASHA worker from Rs.3,000 to Rs.4,000, while that of ASHA supervisors from Rs.9,000 to Rs. 10,500.
86. We have introduced the *Shradhanjali* scheme, to ensure the easy and dignified transportation of mortal remains of people from Assam who pass away due to unforeseen circumstances outside the state.
87. Under *Mission Basundhara*, we started the systematic purification and updation of land records in a mission mode and we fulfilled the promise of distributing land pattas to landless citizens by securing land rights for over 3 lakh beneficiaries, including 24,688 institutions, and settling approximately 4.15 lakh bighas of land, in the last 5 years.
88. The Assam Satra Preservation and Development Commission Bill, 2025 was passed by the Assam Legislative Assembly in November 2025 and we have also cleared thousands of bighas of Satra land from illegal encroachment.
89. For decades, the Assam Accord was a promise left gathering dust, but our Government has officially approved 52 out of the 67 recommendations made by the Justice Biplab Sarma Committee. While we implement these 52 points with full vigor, we are relentlessly pursuing the remaining proposals with the Government of India.

90. With the Charaideo Maidams' inscription as a UNESCO World Heritage Site and securing the 'Classical Language' status for Assamese, we have reclaimed our cultural identity and crowned our heritage.
91. Our Government has signed a loan agreement with the British Museum to bring the historic *Vrindavani Vastra* back to Assam for public exhibition in 2027 after over a century abroad, a significant step in reconnecting the State with this priceless 16th-century cultural treasure.
92. Sir, we showed the unwavering political will to reclaim 162 bighas of our sacred soil and transform Batadrava Than into '*Srimanta Sankardeva Abirbhav Kshetra*', a world-class spiritual and cultural landmark. I bow my head in reverence to the *Gurujana*, Srimanta Sankardeva, whose timeless teachings continue to guide and inspire us.

কুসুম্বৰ পুত্ৰ শ্ৰীশংকৰ গুৰুৱে
ধৰিছিল নামৰে তান
নামৰে সুৰতে আনন্দত নাচিছিল
পৱিত্ৰ বৰদোৱা থান।

93. Fulfilling our pre-election commitment to protect and promote Assam's spiritual and cultural institutions, under *Assam Darshan*, we have released Rs.1132.93 crore to support 54,725 religious places, improving key infrastructure in such places.
94. In the gracious presence of Hon'ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi Ji, we have transformed our heritage into a global spectacle, by celebrating a Guinness World

Record *Bihu* with 11,369 performers, a Mega *Jhumoir* with over 8,000 artists, and a historic *Bagurumba Dwhou* with over 10,000 Bodo artists, and honored performers and trainers with financial awards of Rs.25,000 and Rs.50,000 each. Similar facilitation for *Bagurumba Dwhou* will be done soon.

95. With the construction of *Swahid Smarak Kshetra*, and ongoing Lachit Moidam Memorial we have honoured Assam's heroic legacy.
96. Our Government celebrated the legacy of Kanaklata Barua through the observance of her 100th birth anniversary, commemorated the 400th birth anniversary of Lachit Borphukan, including signing an MoU with Prasar Bharati to produce a 52-episode television series on his life and legacy.
97. We also organized a year-long celebration to mark the 100th birth anniversary of Bharat Ratna, *Sudhakantha* Dr. Bhupen Hazarika.
98. Assam *Sanskritik Mahasangram* drew an overwhelming response with over 10 lakh registrations and enthusiastic participation from thousands of young artists across all districts, making it one of the largest cultural talent initiatives in Assam.
99. Under our pioneering Concert Tourism Policy, the first of its kind in India, we have unlocked the 'Concert Economy' to put Assam on the world map.

100. Sir, we have significantly bolstered the financial strength of our Sixth Schedule Councils, Autonomous Councils and Development Councils. In the last five years, we have ensured a steady and record-breaking flow of grants to our autonomous regions.
101. Our decisive shift towards capital expenditure in the last 5 years has resulted in building the long-term infrastructure and productive assets for Assam.
102. We have constructed 767 Kms of roads under *Asom Mala* with expenditure of almost Rs.8421 crore and 356 kms of National Highways incurring expenditure of Rs.1887 crore in the last 5 years.
103. Under the group of Flagship schemes - *Mukhya Mantrir Pokipath Nirman Achani*, *Mukhya Mantrir Unnata Pakipath Nirman Achani*, *Mukhya Mantrir Mothauri Pokikaran* and *Mukhya Mantrir Nagariya Pokipath Nirman Achani* - 4176 kms of road network has been completed, with expenditure of Rs.6494 crore and additional 6917 kms of road are under various stages of construction.
104. Our Government has completed 21,700 km of road and 1339 bridges at the average rate of nearly 13 km of road per day and 5 bridges per week, in the last 5 years.
105. In 2015, the mighty Brahmaputra had just 3 bridges connecting our people; today, through our Government's unwavering resolve, we have 8 functional bridges and 4 more rising.

106. We have developed the Guwahati-North Guwahati Bridge, the Gateway of Guwahati (GoG) river passenger terminal, the new terminal at Lokapriya Gopinath Bordoloi International Airport, and the *Jyoti-Bishnu Antarjatic Kala Mandir*, building the next generation infrastructure in Assam.
107. In a historic partnership with the Government of India, we are redefining Assam's landscape through a series of unprecedented engineering marvels.
108. The Rs.18,600 crore Gohpur-Numaligarh Underwater Tunnel will be India's first twin-tube, sub-aquatic road-cum-rail corridor that slashes a 6-hour journey to just 30 minutes.
109. The ambitious *Maa Kamakhya Access Corridor (Divyalok Pariyojana)*, the Unity Mall (*Ekta Mall*), Kaziranga elevated corridor with an investment of Rs.6,957 crore, the massive Guwahati Ring Road project, a 121 km engineering marvel and Guwahati-silchar expressway are already underway.
110. Further, the Kokrajhar–Gelephu new railway line, spanning 69 kilometres, has been recently sanctioned under the India–Bhutan connectivity initiative and a highway project is being planned from the semiconductor plant at Jagiroad to Bhutan Border via Udalguri by building another bridge over the Brahmaputra.

111. The visionary proposal to construct the underground railway tracks along a 40-km Siliguri corridor, fortifying ‘Chicken’s Neck’ will create a secure transportation route connecting the Northeast with the rest of India.
112. Our Government’s significant commitment to build next-generation flood and erosion-resilient infrastructure includes the construction of 722.66 km of new embankments, raising and strengthening of almost 863 km of existing embankments. It is reflected in improved embankment performance; breaches have declined from 154 (2016–2021) to 60 (2021 till date), and only 3 in 2025.
113. Speaker Sir, the world is now looking at Assam with new eyes. We have bridged the gap between local potential and global investment in record time. From the banks of the Brahmaputra to the boardrooms of Davos, Assam has arrived on the global stage.
114. With the Tata Semiconductor Plant in Jagiroad; an investment of Rs.27,000 crore, nearing its commissioning this year, we have leapfrogged into the future. Our Hon’ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi Ji has coined the investment and industries growth story of Assam with “*chai* to (semiconductor) chips”, positioning Assam as the future contributor to India’s electronics and chip manufacturing ecosystem, along with global recognition of “Assam tea”.

115. Another transformational step is the upcoming 12.7 LMT Brownfield Ammonia-Urea Complex at Namrup, and Numaligarh Refinery Limited (NRL) expansion project that will create thousands of jobs and energise the region's industrial economy.
116. The cornerstone of our industrial rise is Advantage Assam 2.0, a summit that has redefined our economic destiny. We have secured a monumental Rs.5.18 lakh crore in investment commitments through 296 mega-MoUs, while simultaneously exchanging 2,592 MSE-sector MoUs valued at Rs.6,774 crore across the districts.
117. This industrial revival also focused on the traditional pillars of our economy. Under Assam Tea Industries Special Incentives Scheme (ATISIS), Rs.392 crore has been disbursed to 1914 tea gardens to promote orthodox tea production.
118. While our industrial strides are setting new records, our focus continues to the heart of Assam's economy. Under PM-KISAN, Rs.4,968 crore has been directly transferred to 18.87 lakh farmers in Assam, reflecting a 46% increase in beneficiary coverage since 2021.
119. Under PM *Fasal Bima Yojana*, the enrollment has more than doubled from 4.07 lakh in Kharif 2023 to 9.05 lakh in Kharif 2025, earning national recognition for district-level performance and we have also continued to cap the farmer premium at just Rs.100 per hectare.

120. Our Government has procured 26.19 lakh MT of paddy with disbursement of approx. Rs.5,500 crore, 17,536 MT of mustard by paying Rs.100 crore, and 3,792.16 MT of maize by giving Rs.8.22 crore to farmers across the state. Additional state assistance of Rs.250 per quintal for paddy and maize and Rs.500 per quintal for mustard was given.
121. Sir, aligned with our vision of self-sufficiency in fish production, Assam's fish production has surged by nearly 80%, reaching a record 5.29 lakh metric tonnes.
122. Under the *Axom Adarxo Gram Yojana*, we have sanctioned Rs.256 crore to transform 250 villages into models of self-sustenance and modern infrastructure.
123. Under PMAY - *Gramin*, 17,07,987 Lakh houses have been completed in the last five years, whereas PMAY–Urban positioned Assam as the top-performing North-Eastern state, with 1.82 lakh houses sanctioned and 1.37 lakh completed.
124. Under the RDSS scheme, 1.30 lakh left-out households are being electrified by March 2026, while grid connectivity works in multiple char areas are nearing completion.
125. Our Government has also implemented 90,000 solar rooftops, with aggregate capacity of 300 MW, by providing additional subsidies up to Rs.45,000 under the PM Suryaghar scheme.

126. Through relentless enforcement and the bravery of our forest guards, we have pushed rhino poaching close to zero.
127. To protect both our people and our elephants, we are deploying AI-enabled camera traps under the *Gaja Mitra Scheme*. Simultaneously, we have increased our compassionate support, raising ex-gratia for loss of life to Rs.6 Lakh and crop-damage compensation from Rs.7,500 to Rs.8,000 per bigha.
128. Through the *Amrit Brikshya Andolan*, the people of Assam stood together to plant 1.11 crore seedlings in a single day, creating 10 Guinness World Records, and we also created 160 hectares of nurseries across the forest divisions.
129. Mission *Amrit Sarovar* under the Assam Model is a landmark initiative combining water conservation with sustainable livelihood creation. Against a target of 2,625 *Sarovars*, Assam has successfully achieved 2,963. The total estimated investment stands at about Rs.662 crore, with an average cost of Rs.24 lakh per *Sarovar*. Further, we are launching *Amrit Sarovar 2.0*.
130. Around 50 laws have been amended including 16 under Assam Jan Vishwas Bill, 2025 to decriminalise minor offences and simplify compliance, contributing to Assam's rise in national Ease of Doing Business rankings.

131. Through the CPGRAMS platform, in 2025 alone, we received over 12,000 grievances and resolved nearly 80% of them with lightning speed.
132. In January 2025, we were ranked 4th in the entire country for grievance disposal volume and achieved the 68% citizen satisfaction rate.
133. By elevating Dibrugarh as our Second Capital, establishing the Mini Secretariat in Silchar, and launching a revolutionary Co-District initiative we have permanently erased the distance between the people and their government.
134. Through the historic delimitation of our Panchayats, we have realigned our rural boundaries to ensure that every *Gaon*, *Anchalik*, and *Zilla Parishad* is a perfectly balanced unit of development.

Achievement to Prosperity (সিদ্ধিৰ পৰা সমৃদ্ধিলৈ)

135. Speaker Sir, as we stand at the threshold of this new era for Assam, I envision the next decade of a *Viksit Assam*, where every achievement of today becomes the foundation for a more prosperous, secure, and self-reliant tomorrow.
136. Sir, we have built a new trust with our youth by making government recruitment completely transparent and fair. Strengthening this further, we have formed a Committee to create a 5-year roadmap for providing the maximum possible government jobs to our youth.

137. The Chief Minister's *Atmanirbhar Asom Abhiyaan* (CMAAA) has emerged as a cornerstone of self-employment. Following its initial success, we are expanding its reach to at least 5 lakh more youths, while simultaneously linking our existing beneficiaries with schemes such as MUDRA, Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme (PMEGP) and others to upscale their businesses.
138. A youth-driven logistics support framework and the twin-city development linking Guwahati, Jagiroad, and Palashbari into an urban-industrial corridor is being planned by our Government, aiming at employment-led infrastructure growth.
139. Sir, by moving beyond traditional welfare to a lifecycle approach, Assam is leading the national model for women empowerment.
140. Our resolve to empower *Orunodoi poriyal* will continue with enhanced assistance, and the convergence of *Orunodoi* with major welfare programmes such as NFSA, PMAY-Gramin, PMAY-Urban, and insurance schemes like PM *Suraksha Bima Yojana* (PMSBY), PM *Jeevan Jyoti Bima Yojana* (PJJBY) and *Atal Pension Yojana* (APY).
141. Under MMUA, we have raised the first generation of *Lakhpati Baideu*, and we are now moving to the second phase, by providing Rs.25,000 in further assistance to those who have demonstrated productive utilisation of their initial assistance.

142. The nutritional support extended to our citizens under a subsidised price is so successful that our citizens are now prioritizing these essential nutrients alongside their free NFSA rice. Further, we have planned to deepen our resolve by adding mustard oil to this support.
143. I am pleased to highlight that the success of *Nijut Moina* is visible in an 8.2% reduction in dropouts among girl students between FY 2023-24 and FY 2024-25, and an increase in Gross Enrollment ratio for girls by 4.2% at secondary level and 7.5% at senior secondary level. This significant success has already established a clear and powerful mandate for expansion of *Nijut Moina* and *Nijut Babu* schemes in the years to come.
144. Further, we are transforming our *Vishwavidyalayas* into hubs of the future by equipping our students with cutting-edge skills in Artificial Intelligence and Industry 4.0.
145. The Government had amended and notified “The Assam Education (Provincialisation of Services of Teachers and Reorganisation of Educational Institution) (Amendment) Act 2025. A portal will be opened to initiate the process and facilitate the provincialisation of the services of eligible Teachers or tutors.
146. In a gesture of deep respect for our educators, we are planning to implement ‘*Gurudakshina*’ to provide a one-time relief to teachers and tutors whose services could not be provincialized under the law, ensuring that their lifelong dedication to our children is honored with dignity.

147. Our resolve to strengthen our state's lifeline by upgrading the road network will continue with the launch of *Asom Mala* 4.0.
148. Our long term vision will be towards developing a four-lane between Tezpur and Baihata Chariali, a bridge over Brahmaputra connecting Nagaon-Morigaon and Darrang, Guwahati airport to Jagiroad elevated corridor, and Guwahati to Dibrugarh express corridor.
149. We have also requested the Government of India for expansion of air connectivity by conducting the feasibility study of five (05) new airports in Assam, viz. Nagaon, Diphu, Umrangso, Majuli and Manas.
150. I am happy to state that the export of orthodox tea has registered a substantial increase by 40 million kgs in FY 2025-26. Recognising this achievement, we aim to make Orthodox tea half of our total export. We are increasing the Orthodox tea production subsidy from Rs.10 to Rs.15 per kilogram, with a clear commitment to raise it even further in the future, and strategically positioning Assam to capture the global markets opened by India's new Free Trade Agreements (FTAs), with UK, EU and USA.
151. The prosperity of our tea industry must flow directly to the hands of our tea garden workers; therefore, I am pleased to share that we are finalizing discussions with tea associations to announce enhanced wages for our tea garden workers within this year.

152. For generations, our tea garden brothers and sisters lived as “informal inhabitants” on the land they tilled. Sir, we have changed history. Through the Assam Fixation of Ceiling on Land Holdings (Amendment) Act, 2025, we intend to grant permanent land rights to over 3.5 lakh families across more than 800 Tea estates of Assam. We are expecting Hon’ble Prime Minister Narendra Modi ji to officially start the distribution of tea garden land patta in March, ensuring our strong commitment to protect their rights.
153. This will further enable our tea garden workers to be considered for getting housing benefits under PMAY-G, improving their living conditions.
154. The quantity of paddy procured in KMS 2020-21 was 2.11 lakh MT. Due to the steps to augment the required infrastructure and financing, the quantity of paddy procured has increased more than 4 (four) times, as the quantity procured in the last KMS 2024-25 was 8.50 lakh MT. This in turn means that this year, our farmers have received Rs.1955 crore as MSP, which was only Rs.394 crore in KMS 2020-21. We will continue to focus on supporting farmers with the top up subsidy and aim to make Assam *Atmanirbhar* in production of paddy, mustard and maize.
155. Sir, Assam has been able to supply power for 23.81 hours in urban areas and 23.40 hours in rural areas, which are above national average hours of power supply.

156. We have added around 1,000 MW of green power capacity in the last five years. By further setting up 3,000 MW of solar and battery storage projects, 4,600 MW four pumped storage projects, and 3,200 MW ultra-supercritical thermal power project, we are taking Assam towards the surplus power state, who will be able to supply power to other northeastern states and neighboring countries.
157. Additionally, Lower Kopili Hydro Electric Project is getting commissioned, to increase the state generation capacity up to 1300 MW.
158. Our move towards power-surplus Assam will also enable us to develop an ecosystem for Data Centres in the region. These modern data centres are increasingly AI-optimized, built with high-density GPU infrastructure and hyperscale capacity to support cloud and semiconductor ecosystems.

In Closing Reflection (*Xamuroni Protifolon*)

159. Hon'ble Speaker Sir, while placing this Vote on Account, I take this opportunity to thank the people of Assam once again for the confidence they have posed in our Government and giving us a stable term of five years. We are leaving no stone unturned to serve the people of Assam. I would like to thank the Hon'ble Members of this august House, the officers and employees of the State Government for their incessant efforts towards realizing the vision of *Viksit Assam*.

160. Sir, the various reports stipulated under the Assam Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (AFRBM) Act will be submitted at the time of introduction of the full Budget. The purpose of this Vote on Account is to seek approval for expenditure for the initial few months of the financial year 2026-27 to ensure uninterrupted delivery of public services, timely discharge of committed obligations and smooth implementation of development works already approved by this House.
161. Standing here I reflect upon the journey of the last 4 years and 7 months and hope that future generations cherish the decisions taken by our Government under the visionary leadership of Hon'ble Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma.
162. We have created a work ethic that enabled the realization of *Atal, Avichal, Agragami* Assam. I feel that the commendable works done by our Government will go down in the annals of history.
163. We could fulfil aspirations of citizens of this state by providing more than 1.58 lakh jobs and implementation of schemes such as *Orunodoi*, Chief Minister *Atmanirbhar Assam Abhiyaan*, *Mukhyamantri Mahila Udyamita Abhiyaan*, *Nijut Moina*, Chief Minister's *Jibon Prerana*, Chief Minister's *Jibon Anuprerona*, *Mukhya Mantrir Eti Koli Duti Paat*, etc.
164. The Hon'ble Chief Minister Dr. Himanta Biswa Sarma has devoted all his time and energy in securing the future of every citizen in the state following the philosophy of Bhagawad Gita. As it says:

कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन ।
मा कर्मफलहेतुर्भूर्मा ते सङ्गोऽस्त्वकर्मणि ॥

165. With the ideals of *Mahapurush* Srimanta Sankardeva and the blessings of Maa Kamakhya, we resolve to march forward on the path of *Viksit Assam*.
166. At this moment of completing 5 years of people-oriented governance and amid this environment of emerging and confident Assam, I have submitted my Vote on Account for the year 2026-27 before this august House.

অসম আমাৰ ৰূপহী
গুণৰো নাই শেষ
ভাৰতৰে পূৰ্ব দিশৰ সূৰ্য্য উঠা দেশ।

Hon'ble Speaker, Sir, With these inspiring lines of Dr. Bhupen Hazarika, I seek a Vote on Account on the Demands for Grants for the initial months of the Financial Year 2026–27, amounting to Rs 6229478.30 Lakhs (Rupees Sixty-Two Thousand Two Hundred Ninety-Four Crore, Seventy-Eight Lakh and Thirty Thousand only), to enable the Government to carry on its normal services pending the full Budget.

With faith in the wisdom of this August House and its continued support to our agenda of growth with fiscal prudence, I commend the Vote on Account for approval.

Jai Hind.

Jai Aai Axom.

Appendix - List of Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Full Form
AAHII	Assam Advanced Healthcare Innovation Institute
ACCF	Assam Cancer Care Foundation
ACS	Assam Civil Service
ADB	Asian Development Bank
AE	Advanced Estimate
AEGCL	Assam Electricity Grid Corporation Limited
AGCL	Assam Gas Company Limited
AHSSP	Assam Health Systems Strengthening Project
AI	Artificial Intelligence
AIF	Alternate Investment Fund
AIIMS	All India Institute of Medical Sciences
AMRUT	Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation
APDCL	Assam Power Distribution Company Limited
APGCL	Assam Power Generation Corporation Limited
APS	Assam Police Service
ASHA	Accredited Social Health Activist
ASTC	Assam State Transport Corporation
ATISIS	Assam Tea Industries Special Incentives Scheme

ATPO	Assam Trade Promotion Organisation
AVFU	Assam Veterinary and Fishery University
AWC	Anganwadi Centre
AWH	Anganwadi Helper
AWW	Anganwadi Worker
BE	Budget Estimate
BOP	Border Out Post
BTC	Bodoland Territorial Council
BTR	Bodoland Territorial Region
CCTNS	Crime and Criminal Tracking Network & Systems
CCTV	Closed Circuit Television
CD	Credit-Deposit Ratio
CIDF	City Infrastructure Development Fund
CMAAA	Chief Minister's Atmanirbhar Asom Abhiyan
CMSGUY	Chief Minister Samagra Gramya Unnayan Yojana
CNG	Compressed Natural Gas
CPGRAMS	Centralized Public Grievance Redress and Monitoring System
DBT	Direct Benefit Transfer
DHAC	Dima Hasao Autonomous Council
DIDS	Digital Infrastructure for DBT Schemes
EAP	Externally Aided Project

ESIC	Employees' State Insurance Corporation
EU	European Union
FSTP	Faecal Sludge Treatment Plants
FY	Financial Year
GeM	Government e-Marketplace
GI	Geographical Indication
GMCH	Gauhati Medical College and Hospital
GPU	Graphics Processing Unit
GSDP	Gross State Domestic Product
IGNOAPS	Indira Gandhi National Old Age Pension Scheme
IGNWPS	Indira Gandhi National Widow Pension Scheme
JICA	Japan International Cooperation Agency
KAAC	Karbi Anglong Autonomous Council
KMS	Kharif Marketing Season
LAC	Legislative Assembly Constituency
LED	Light-emitting diode
MGNREGA	Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act
MoU	Memorandum of Understanding
MRI	Magnetic Resonance Imaging
MSME	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
MSP	Minimum Support Price

MUDRA	Micro Units Development and Refinance Agency
MW	Megawatt
MWp	Megawatt peak
NABARD	National Bank for Agriculture and Rural Development
NDDB	National Dairy Development Board
NFDB	National Fisheries Development Board
NFSA	National Food Security Act
NH	National Highway
NOC	No Objection Certificate
NRL	Numaligarh Refinery Limited
OBC	Other Backward Classes
ODOP	One District One Product
OIL	Oil India Limited
PMAY	Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana
PM-KISAN	Pradhan Mantri Kisan Samman Nidhi
RDSS	Revamped Distribution Sector Scheme
RIDF	Rural Infrastructure Development Fund
ROB	Road Over Bridge
SHG	Self Help Group
SPSE	State Public Sector Enterprise
STEM	Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics

STP	Sewage Treatment Plants
SVAMITVA	Survey of Villages and Mapping with Improvised Technology in Village Areas
TPD	Tonnes Per Day
T-VET	Technical and Vocational Education and Training
UK	United Kingdom
UIDF	Urban Infrastructure Development Fund
ULB	Urban Local Body
ULFA	United Liberation Front of Asom
UNESCO	United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization
USA	United States of America
